

RANK-10	INDIAN INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT SHILLONG
OVERALL SCORE	763.9
PLACEMENT PERFORMANCE	100% placement, with a median salary of ₹26 lakh per annum
CAMPUS EXPERIENCE	The campus is located in Meghalaya's hills, blending academic infrastructure with strong sustainability ethos giving it a distinct identity. Spread over 120 acres and often called the "campus in the clouds", it is self-contained and futuristic in design with world class sports and recreation facilities
NEW INITIATIVES	• The IIM Shillong Foundation for Incubation and Enterprises has emerged as a growing entrepreneurship and innovation ecosystem in the North-East

preneurship, sustainability, responsible business and emerging technologies. It helps students understand how technology changes strategy, organisations and society," says Sherry.

At the same time, there is no question of taking one's eyes off the basics. "Technology may change but the ability to think critically, make sound decisions, lead people and understand institutions remain indispensable." The objective is to create future-ready managers.

THE TOP GEAR

The first few years are the most challenging for a B-school. At IIM Shillong, the task on hand is to translate that momentum into sustained institutional excellence.

Global accreditations—AACSB (Association to Advance Collegiate Schools of Business) and EQUIS (considered to be the most comprehensive institutional accreditation system for business and management schools)—opens many opportunities.

Sherry points to the key priorities at this point. "We need to deepen our academic and research capabilities. IIM Shillong must contribute more significantly to management thought and knowledge creation," he says. Then, there is the piece on strengthening global engagement. With the accreditations, Sherry is looking to "build deeper international academic collaborations, student and faculty exchanges, research partnerships and greater global visibility."

Getting back to what's taking place in the North-East, the plan is to make the connection between the institute, industry and the region even stronger. "Shillong and the wider North-East have significant potential in areas like entrepreneurship, tourism, technology, sustainability and knowledge-based services," he says. In his own mind, there is clear role for the B-school to act as a catalyst for managerial capability, innovation and entrepreneurship in the region.

Sherry is candid as he talks about what an IIM should represent in a rapidly changing world. "The temptation in management education is to chase rankings, technology and immediate market trends. Our larger responsibility is to build an institution that remains relevant across cycles and creates enduring value for students, industry and society," he says. In every sense, it promises to be a phase of transformation. "It is about moving from growth to institution-building, from recognition to global relevance, and from being a leading B-school to becoming a distinctive centre of knowledge, leadership, and impact," adds Sherry. Clearly, a lot is waiting to play out at IIM Shillong. BT

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